

Concept Note for Microeconomics Product Assignment Sem 1

1. This assignment is based on understanding the Economics of both Production (= Supply and Cost) as well as earnings from the sale of the produced item (Demand and Revenue). The assignment also aims at making the student engage with how the Factor Market (back-end) and the Product Market (front end) for the allotted item operates.
2. The assignment aims at giving students an exposure to the various **economic** realities that the manufacturing, selling and buying of products entails. Hence get students to appreciate, comprehend and apply to reality the various relevant micro-economic concepts and theories that they have been taught in the areas of Demand for and the consequent Revenues earned as well as the Production of and so the Costs incurred wrt the products that have been allotted.
3. This assignment tracks the innocuous product allotted to the student on the following aspects of the product:
 - 3.1. The production modality of the product. This involves the type of technology used and the changes in the technology employed over time.
 - 3.2. The raw materials used and the areas / regions from where they are procured by the producers.
 - 3.3. The basic costing involved in producing the product (both Op-Ex as well as Cap-Ex).
 - 3.4. The product's supply-chain at both the backend as well as the frontend.
 - 3.5. The major places (in Mumbai) where this (finished) product can be purchased at wholesale rates.
 - 3.6. The manner in which the prices are determined – both wholesale and retail prices.
 - 3.7. The type of elasticity of demand involved (price elasticity is compulsory, the other types of elasticity is optional (but if correctly and aptly introduced into the assignment will fetch additional marks).
 - 3.8. The competitive nature of the product market that the allotted product mainly operates within.
 - 3.9. The nature of the selling costs involved in reaching the product to the consumers.
 - 3.10. Justify if the product is a 'sunset' / 'sunrise' / 'evergreen' one; engage with its various versions over time.
 - 3.11. The government's policy with respect to the allotted product.
4. With respect to the product allotted, each student must:
 - 4.1. Study the **BACKEND** aspects of the allotted product by:
 - 4.1.1. Engaging with the various production processes and decisions involved with the making of the said product (across all its available versions).
 - 4.1.2. Scrutinizing the costs by the firm involved in creating allotted product.
 - 4.1.3. Probing into the supply-chain involved with the selling of the allotted product.
 - 4.1.4. Examining government policies connected with the allotted product.
 - 4.2. Study **FRONTEND** aspects of the allotted product by:
 - 4.2.1. Understanding the nature of the demand for the allotted product.
 - 4.2.2. Looking into the revenue generated for the various stakeholders involved.
 - 4.2.3. Reviewing the marketing techniques involved in the product's sales promotion.
 - 4.2.4. Assignments that undertake a consumer survey and draw relevant inferences using regression (via Excel), would be appropriately appreciated while being evaluated.

5. Each student is expected to write a 20 marks - 2000 words essay containing the following via-a-vis the allotted product:
- 5.1. Introduction, (history = evolution) would have to be described. (3 marks)
 - 5.2. Backend description. (6 marks)
 - 5.3. Frontend description. (6 marks)
 - 5.4. Suggestions to improve service's production and delivery efficiency. (3 marks)
 - 5.5. Lessons learned (each team member separately writing at least 4 points). (2 marks)
6. Essay's format:
Page Size: A4, Margins (in inches): 1, 1, 1 and 1.5 (Top, Right, Bottom and Left), Font: New Times Roman, Font Size: 12 for the body's text, 14 and bold for the titles and subtitles, Line spacing: 1.5, FULL JUSTIFICATION with PAGINATION is mandatory.
7. The Submission details:
- 7.1. Soft copy as a PDF, sent to agnelo.menezes@xaviers.edu
 - 7.2. Date Deadline: As decided in Class (The Saturday of the one week after the last End-Sem Exam; 11.30 pm)
 - 7.3. Email's subject: Student's Roll No followed by the product name of the product (e.g., 0000, Study of Landline Phones).
 - 7.4. Cover page contents: Name, Roll No., Class, Semester and Academic Year, Institute's Name

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